PEW RESEARCH CENTER
DECEMBER 8-11, 2011 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,008

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
b. Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Europe					
December 8-11, 2011	14	22	27	37	1
December 1-4, 2011	14	24	25	36	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
November 10-13, 2011: *Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Greece and Italy*	15	23	23	38	1
November 3-6, 2011: *Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Greece and other European countries*	18	26	21	34	1
October 27-30, 2011	12	27	24	36	*
September 29-October 2, 2011: *The debt crisis in Greece and other European countries*	15	21	24	39	1
September 15-18, 2011	16	23	24	37	1
August 18-21, 2011: *The debate among European leaders on how to address the region's debt crisis*	12	21	22	44	1
August 11-14, 2011: *Riots in London and other parts of* Britain	17	28	21	32	1
June 30-July 3, 2011: *The financial crisis and violent protests in Greece*	14	22	23	39	1
June 16-19, 2011	10	20	25	45	1
May 13-16, 2010: *A trillion-dollar bailout package for European governments facing debt problems*	21	26	24	28	2
May 7-10, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece and violent protests there*	19	23	26	31	*
April 30-May 3, 2010: *The financial crisis in Greece*	6	15	28	51	1
October, 1998: *Financial instability around the world*	32	40	19	9	*
September, 1998: *Economic and political instability in Russia*	18	30	28	24	*
Late August, 1998: *Economic problems in Russia*	8	22	29	41	*
January, 1998: *The deepening financial crisis in many Asian countries*	15	25	27	33	*
March, 1995: *The financial and political instability in Mexico*	12	28	30	29	1
c. Deadly shootings at Virginia Tech University					
December 8-11, 2011	20	27	29	24	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 7-10, 2011: *A shooting at a fitness club in Pennsylvania*	13	28	25	34	1
June 12-15, 2009: *A deadly shooting at the Holocaust Memorial Museum in Washington, D.C.*	26	34	17	23	*
April 3-6, 2009: *A shooter killing several people at an immigration services center in Binghamton, New York*	26	32	19	23	*
March 13-16, 2009: *A shooting spree in Alabama that resulted in the death of 11 people*	18	33	24	25	*
February 15-18, 2008: *The shootings at Northern Illinois University that resulted in the death of 7 people*	26	40	19	15	0

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
February 8-11, 2008: *A shooting at a city council meeting in Missouri where six people were killed*	13	28	25	33	1
December 14-17, 2007: *Shootings at two religious centers in Colorado*	17	31	24	27	1
December 7-10, 2007: *A shooting at a shopping mall in Omaha, Nebraska where eight people were killed*	30	36	18	15	1
October 12-15, 2007: *The shooting at a high school in Cleveland, Ohio*	22	32	25	20	1
April 20-23, 2007: *The shootings at Virginia Tech University that resulted in the death of 33 people*	45	37	13	5	*
October, 2006: *Recent shootings at schools in Pennsylvania and other states*	46	33	12	8	1
March, 2000: *The shooting of a 6-year-old girl at a Michigan school*	40	38	15	7	*
September, 1999: *The shootings in a Jewish community center in Los Angeles*	29	34	22	14	1
Late April, 1999: *The shooting of students and teachers by two students at a Colorado high school*	68	24	6	2	*
June, 1998: *The shooting at a high school in Springfield, Oregon*	46	36	14	4	*
March, 1998: *The shooting at a middle school in Jonesboro, Arkansas*	49	33	12	5	1
d. Anti-Wall Street protests in several cities around the country					
December 8-11, 2011	17	27	26	30	1
November 17-20, 2011	20	30	24	25	1
November 10-13, 2011	16	30	24	29	1
November 3-6, 2011	18	29	22	30	1
October 27-30, 2011: *Anti-Wall Street protests in New York and other cities*	19	27	23	31	1
October 20-23, 2011	19	29	20	31	1
October 13-16, 2011	22	31	21	26	1
October 6-9, 2011	17	25	22	35	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
March 10-13, 2011: *Disputes in Wisconsin and other states between state governments and public employee unions*	30	26	18	25	1
March 3-6, 2011	29	24	19	27	1
February 24-27, 2011	36	22	15	26	1
April 16-19, 2010: *Anti-government protests on April 15*	16	21	21	41	1
April 17-20, 2009: *Tea party protests against taxes and government spending*	27	25	22	25	1
May, 2000: *The protests in Washington, D.C., at the annual meetings of the World Bank and International Monetary Fund*	6	18	32	43	1
December, 1999: *The protests in Seattle at the World Trade Organization meeting*	18	30	27	24	1
e. A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University					
December 8-11, 2011	24	29	24	22	1
November 17-20, 2011: *A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University*	28	31	21	18	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
November 10-13, 2011: *A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University resulting in the firing of the school's president and football coach Joe Paterno*	34	29	19	18	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
August 18-21, 2011: *Recent scandals in college football*	10	12	17	61	*
September 16-19, 2010: *Pope Benedict's visit to Great Britain and his comments on the Catholic Church's handling of sex-abuse scandals*	10	16	26	47	1
April 23-26, 2010: *Reports about the Vatican's handling of sex-abuse scandals in the Catholic Church*	14	28	29	29	*
March 26-29, 2010	17	24	28	30	*
March 19-22, 2010	8	18	31	42	1
June, 2002: *Reports of sexual abuses by Catholic priests*	38	36	17	8	1
May, 2002: *The Pope and American cardinals meeting in Rome about sexual abuse by Catholic priests*	27	33	21	18	1
Early April, 2002: *Reports of sexual abuses by Catholic priests*	27	34	25	13	1
December, 1993	18	32	31	18	1
f. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections					
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

Dec 1-4 2011	
19	News about candidates for the 2012 presidential elections
18	A sex abuse scandal at Penn State University
18	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
10	Deadly shootings at Virginia Tech University
6	Anti-Wall Street protests in several cities around the country
6	Efforts to deal with the debt crisis in Europe
7	Some other story **(VOL.)**
16	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:
Now a different kind of question…
PEWWP.1 As I name a few Republican candidates for president please tell me the ONE word that comes to mind. First, **[INSERT FIRST ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**. **[IF "DON'T KNOW" PROBE ONCE WITH:** It can be anything, just the ONE word that comes to mind…] How about, **[INSERT NEXT ITEM] [OPEN END: ENTER VERBATIM RESPONSE, RECORD FIRST MENTION ONLY]**[1]

a. Newt Gingrich

Dec 8-11 2011	
29	No/No way
20	Intelligent
20	Old/Old timer/Old school
17	Conservative
16	Idiot
15	Smart/Smartest
14	Good
14	Knowledgeable
13	Crook/Crooked
12	Experienced
10	Possible/Possibility
9	Liar
7	Like/Likeable
7	OK
7	Speaker/House Speaker
7	Untrustworthy
6	Arrogant
6	Bad
6	Interesting
6	Joke
6	Politician
5	Fair
5	Pompous
5	President
5	Slimy/Slime ball
5	Stupid
5	Newt/Newt Gingrich
4	Adulterer
4	Blowhard
4	Bullsh*t
4	Dishonest/Not honest
4	Hypocrite/Hypocritical
4	Don't trust/Distrust/Not trustworthy
4	Jerk
4	Questionable
4	Talk/Talkative/Talker
4	Trustworthy
3	Alright
3	Ass/Ass****
3	Awful
3	Brilliant
3	Business/Businessman
3	Decent
3	Fake/Faker

Continued

b. Mitt Romney

Dec 8-11 2011	
47	Mormon
23	No/No way
19	Flip-flop/Flip flopper/Flipper
15	Good/Good man
15	OK
10	Religion/Religious
9	Business/Businessman
9	Honest
9	Not sure/Unsure
9	Possibility/Possible
8	Loser
8	Slick
7	Conservative
7	Crook/Crooked
7	Idiot
7	Like
7	Wishy-washy
6	Rich
5	Boring
5	Liar
5	Moderate
4	Alright
4	Bland
4	Candidate
4	Confident
4	Dumb
4	Fair
4	Intelligent/Intelligence
4	Interesting
4	Maybe
4	Politician
4	President/Presidential
4	Questionable/Questions
4	Smart
4	Steady
4	Stupid
4	Untrustworthy
3	Bad
3	Competent
3	Dull
3	Electable
3	Experienced
3	Fake
3	Jerk
3	Liberal

Continued

Oct 13-16 2011	
60	Mormon
17	Health care/Health program
13	Flip-flop/Flip-flopper/Flipper
13	Good/Good man
12	No/No way
12	Possibility/Possible
11	Religion/Religious
10	Intelligent/Intelligence
10	Moderate
10	Old
9	Boring
9	OK
9	Politician
8	Competent
8	President/Presidential
7	Conservative
7	Honest
7	Not sure/Unsure
7	Questionable/Questions
7	Business/Businessman
6	Established/Establishment
6	Fair
6	Fake
5	Experience
5	Liar
5	Liberal
5	Like
5	Money
5	Qualified
5	Rich
5	Strong
4	Best
4	Capable
4	Confident
4	Crook/Crooked
4	Dull
4	Front runner
4	Jobs
4	Loser
4	Not interested/Uninterested
4	Republican
3	Alright
3	Ass
3	Bad
3	Candidate

[1] PEWWP.1a-b asked in conjunction with *The Washington Post*.

PEWWP.1 CONTINUED…

a. Newt Gingrich (Cont.)

Dec 8-11 2011	
3	Goof/Goofy
3	Don't like/Dislike
3	Immoral
3	Insider
3	Loser
3	Not interested
3	Progressive
3	Racist
3	Republican
3	Scary
3	Terrible
2	Aggressive
312	Other
31	Nothing/None/No idea
292	Don't know

b. Mitt Romney (Cont.)

Dec 8-11 2011	
3	Not interested/Uninterested
3	Republican
3	Undecided
2	Best
2	Capable
2	Decent
2	Distrust/Mistrust
2	Front-runner
2	Health care/Health program/Mass. health care
2	Massachusetts
2	Money
2	Nice
2	Smooth
2	Stable
1	Established/Establishment
1	Hypocrite
1	Romneycare
24	No answer/Nothing
274	Other
351	Don't know

(Cont.)

Oct 13-16 2011	
3	Decent
3	Distrust/Mistrust
3	Electable
3	Hypocrite
3	Jerk
3	Massachusetts
3	New York
3	Nice
3	Smooth
3	Stable
3	Undecided
10	No answer
296	Other
313	Don't know

NOTE: The numbers listed represent the number of respondents who offered each response; the numbers are not percentages.

Now thinking about the Occupy Wall Street movement…
RANDOMIZE PEW.2A AND PEW.2B
ASK ALL:
PEW.2A Do you agree or disagree with the concerns the Occupy Wall Street movement protests have raised?

Dec 8-11 2011	
48	Agree
30	Disagree
22	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

RANDOMIZE PEW.2A AND PEW.2B
ASK ALL:
PEW.2b Do you approve or disapprove of the way the Occupy Wall Street movement protests are being conducted?

Dec 8-11 2011	
29	Approve
49	Disapprove
23	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**